MADAGASCAR

A BIODIVERSITY HOTSPOT

where it is located

Why is Madagascar considered a biodiversity hotspot

- Extremely high number of endemic species (plants and animals found nowhere else).
- Long geographic isolation allowed unique species to evolve.
- Rich variety of ecosystems such as rainforests, dry forests, and mangroves.

Animal Examples

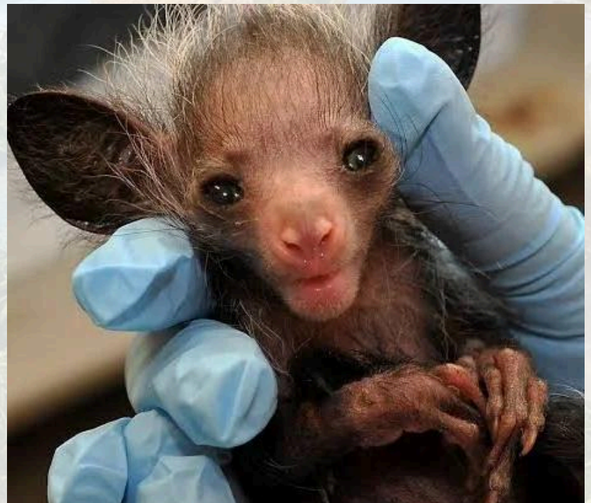
panther chameleon

ring tail lemur

fossa

day gecko

aye aye



PLANTS

Example

octupus tree

madagascar periwinkle

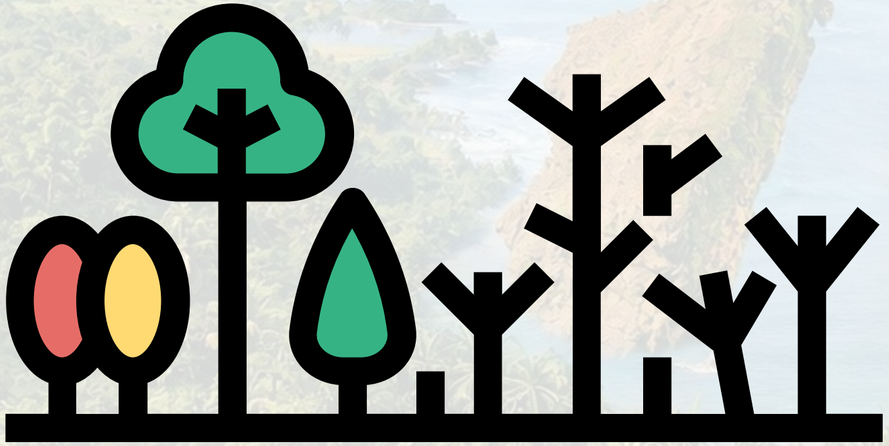
ravenala plant

gradndider boabob

Threats

- forests are cleared for farming, timber, and charcoal.
- local farming method that destroys habitats.
- some animals are hunted for food or pets.
- non-native plants and animals compete with native species.
- affects rainfall, temperature, and ecosystems.
- extraction of minerals can destroy natural habitats.

Conservation methods



- preserve forests and habitats for animals and plants.
- planting native trees to restore destroyed forests.
- teaching local people the importance of wildlife and conservation.
- using eco-friendly methods instead of slash-and-burn.
- encouraging tourism that supports conservation and local communities.
- enforcing rules to stop illegal hunting and trade of wildlife.

https://earth.google.com/web/@-16.99678889,42.20688642,-8070.85020775a,6304679.7424221d,35y,0h,0t,0r/data=CgRCAggBMikKJwolCiExNEJkdG4tX19qbldVclZmeXp6SUE2ak5mVGJ1MmdJN2cgAToDCgEwQgIIAEoICOvhwvoCEAE
https://lemur.duke.edu/8-20-ll1/#:~:text=Because%20Madagascar%20has%20been%20an,85%25%20of%20animals%20are%20endemic.
https://wildlifemadagascar.org/animals/panther-chameleon/https://www.sfzoo.org/panther-chameleon/https://nationalzoo.si.edu/animals/ring-tailed-lemurhttps://www.nationalgeographic.com/animals/mammals/facts/ring-tailed-lemurhttps://www.thesprucepets.com/day-geckos-as-pets-1236908https://www.nationalgeographic.com/animals/mammals/facts/aye-ayehttps://fossa.com/https://tsusinvasives.org/home/database/schefflera-actinophyllahttps://www.kew.org/plants/madagascar-periwinklehttps://www.inaturalist.org/taxa/62924-Catharanthus-roseushttps://psfaculty.plantsciences.ucdavis.edu/courses/enh101/Favorite%20Tree,PDFs/KathleenO'leary.pdfhttps://www.nparks.gov.sg/florafaunaweb/flora/3/1/3100https://www.worldwildlife.org/places/madagascar/https://www.wildmadagascar.org/conservation/threats.htmlhttps://www.conservation.org/places/madagascarhttps://wildlifemadagascar.org/wildlife-madagascar-strategic-plan-2025-2030-2/